# Report: Certificates - Tier 1 Painted Door Winners - Company Prioritization Study

November 2024

## Background & Objectives

**Objective:** Prioritize companies per Tier 1 subject
**Why our company choice matters:** Insights - 2025 Planning
**Research plan:** Painted Door Winners Certificate - Research Plan - November 2024

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## Summary

1. **Stanford:** As we've seen in previous studies, Stanford scores highly across most subjects as respondents view universities as most credible for certificate programs and are generally very associated with this type of learning.
    a. Hard skills knowledge (data, finance), tactical skills (planning, growth), or even soft skills (negotiation, leadership) all seem to resonate for Stanford so there's room to play depending where Stanford is willing to engage.
    b. **Recommend:** Pursue conversations with Stanford around the top three subjects where Stanford scores highest: Strategic Planning, Negotiation, and Data Analysis.

| | Stanford |
|---|---|
| Strategic Planning | 36 |
| Negotiation | 34 |
| Data Analysis | 34 |
| Team Leadership | 32 |
| Growth Strategy | 32 |
| Corporate Finance | 31 |
| Sales Leadership | 29 |
| Product Management | 29 |
| Investment Analysis | 27 |
| Sales Strategy | 26 |
| Product Marketing | 20 |
| Artificial Intelligence | 18 |
| Emerging Tech | 9 |

2. **<u>MasterClass Standalone</u>**: The subjects where MasterClass scores highly could be good standalone Cert options. Our standalone leans towards soft skill (leadership) or practitioner / tactical (product mktg and mgmt, strategic planning, growth). Standalone hard skills certs are not recommended from us alone.
    a. **Recommend:** Sales Leadership is a good first option for us, if that is the angle we choose to take in a Sales class (over Strategic Sales). Sales follow up research here.

| | **MasterClass** |
|---|---|
| Team Leadership | 16 |
| Sales Leadership | 15 |
| Product Marketing | 14 |
| Product Management | 13 |
| Strategic Planning | 11 |
| Growth Strategy | 11 |
| Sales Strategy | 9 |
| Negotiation | 8 |
| Corporate Finance | 6 |
| Data Analysis | 5 |
| Investment Analysis | 1 |
| Emerging Tech | -1 |
| Artificial Intelligence | -6 |

3. **<u>Big consumer tech brands will drive high interest however we feature them:</u>**
    a. **Google, Microsoft, Apple,** and **Amazon** resonate across most subjects. This is also likely due to high awareness of these brands, but definitely something to keep in mind that these high awareness consumer tech brands drive strong interest.
    b. We could essentially put Google or Microsoft across any of these: Team Leadership, Data Analysis (Google Analytics), Emerging Tech, Strategic Planning, Sales Leadership, Growth Strategy, Product Management, Product Marketing, and Sales Strategy
    c. **Recommend:** Prioritize these big brands even as instructors in MC Only Certs if we can't get them for a full cert.

4. **<u>Current pipeline has solid contenders, with Microsoft > Anthropic and Morgan Stanley > Carlyle in this test:</u>**
    a. **AI:** Microsoft AI ranks #2; Anthropic ranks towards the bottom in AI; similar to what we've seen in previous studies. Latest AI report here.

b. **Corporate Finance:** Morgan Stanley ranks #4; Carlyle ranks towards the bottom. Plan is to follow up with a dev study on this subject - tbd timing,
c. **Sales:** Sales Leadership is the 2nd highest ranked subject for MasterClass (after Team Leadership) and Sales Strategy ranks in the middle of the pack for MasterClass. Potential brands / instructors we can feature for Sales Leadership: Google, Microsoft, Apple, Amazon, Salesforce

5. **Top 5 companies per subject** (in addition to Stanford and MasterClass) to be shortlisted:

| *Stanford and MasterClass* | |
|---|---|
| **Artificial Intelligence** | Open AI, Microsoft AI, MIT, Amazon AI, Google DeepMind |
| **Team Leadership** | Google, Microsoft, *Stanford,* Apple, Amazon, Navy SEALs |
| **Data Analysis & Decision Making** | Google Analytics, Microsoft (Power BI), *Stanford*, AWS, IBM, Oracle |
| **Emerging Tech** | Google, Microsoft, Apple, MIT, Amazon |
| **Strategic Planning** | *Stanford*, Google, Microsoft, Harvard Business Review, MIT Sloan, *MasterClass,* Amazon |
| **Sales Leadership** | Google, Microsoft, *Stanford*, Apple, Amazon, Salesforce |
| **Growth Strategy** | Microsoft, Google, Amazon, Apple, *Stanford*, LinkedIn |
| **Product Management** | Google, Microsoft, Amazon, *Stanford,* Apple, LinkedIn |
| **Product Marketing** | Google, Amazon, Microsoft, Apple, *Stanford*, Samsung |
| **Corporate Finance** | JP Morgan, *Stanford*, Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, Visa, Berkshire Hathaway |
| **Sales Strategy** | Google, Microsoft, Amazon, Apple, *Stanford*, Salesforce |
| **Negotiation** | Harvard Law, Yale Law, *Stanford Law*, University of Chicago Law, The Schranner Negotiation Institute, JP Morgan |
| **Investment Analysis** | Fidelity, JPMorganChase, Charles Schwab, *Stanford*, Vanguard, Morgan Stanley |

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## Full Details

How to read:

- The higher the score, the more preferred it is.
- Positive scores = chosen more often as best than worst.
- Negative score = chosen more often as worst than best.
- **Focus on the positives as our priority targets.**
- **Subjects where MasterClass scores positive + higher = potential contenders for MC alone certs**

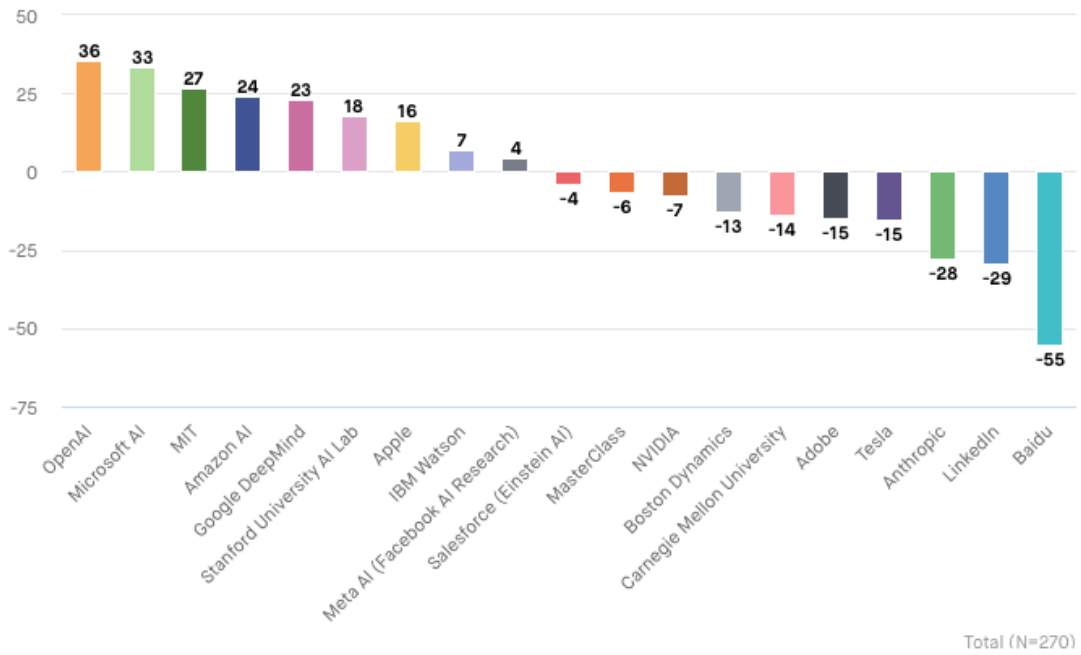
Reminder of user experience:

- Select subject from list of 13
- MaxDiff question for the subjects selected (up to 3)

- MaxDiff question: *Imagine you could learn Corporate Finance: Strategies for Value Creation from a few different companies who would directly teach you how they approach this subject. Please select the company that you personally believe would be the best for you to learn the subject from and the company that you believe would be the worst for you to learn the subject from.*
- Respondent goes through a series of exercises in which they choose their best and worst brand for that subject

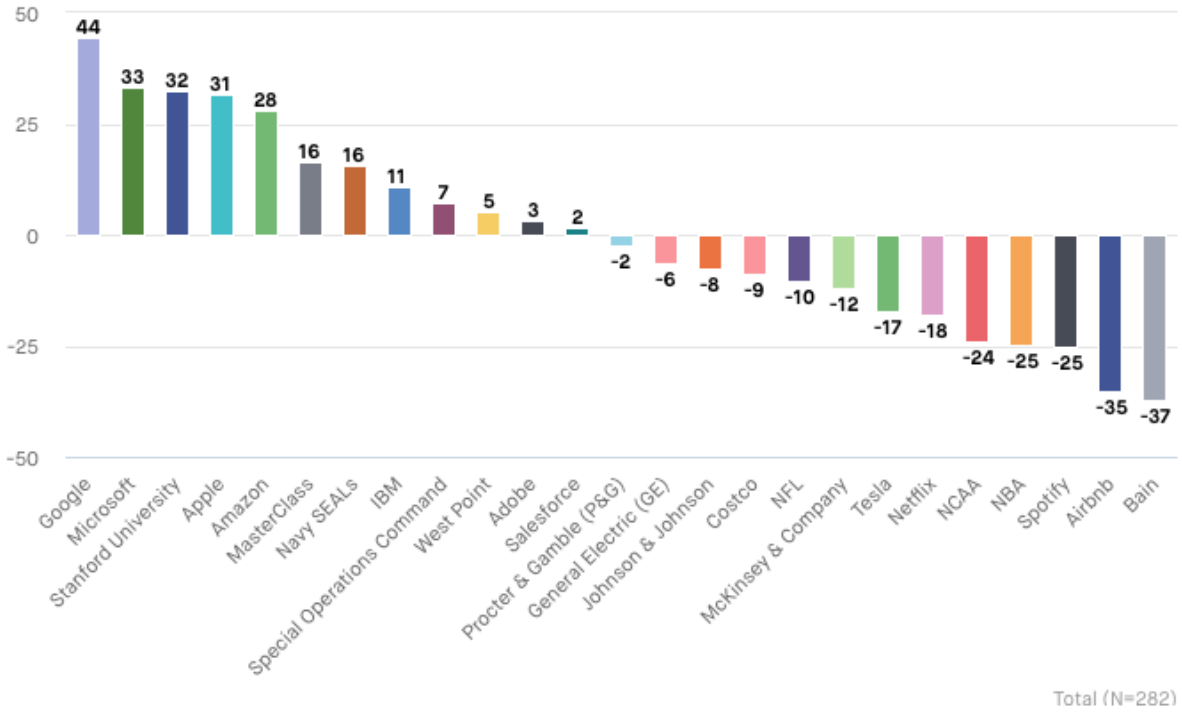
## Artificial Intelligence

- OpenAI scored #1 with Microsoft AI in 2nd. Anthropic scores towards the end, as it is more niche. We've also seen that reflected in the [NVIDIA study](NVIDIA study).



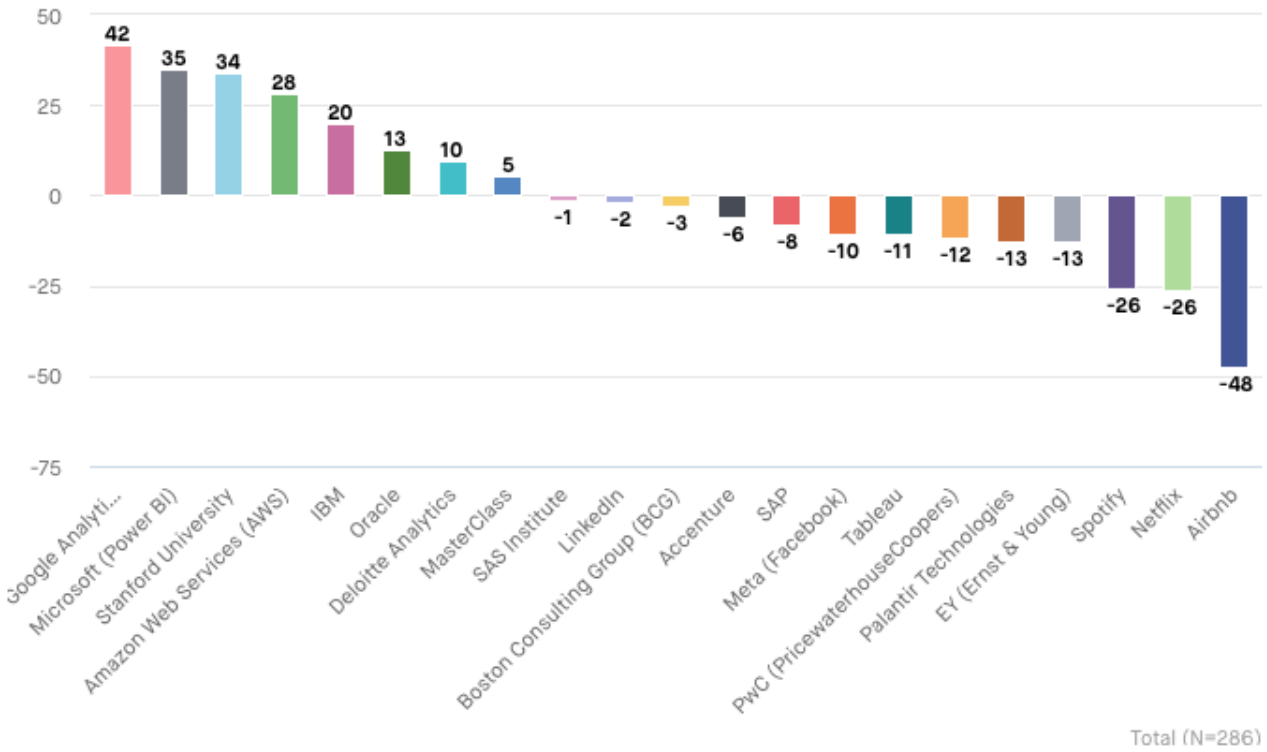

## Team Leadership

- A good MasterClass potential standalone class
- Google would be a good brand to feature



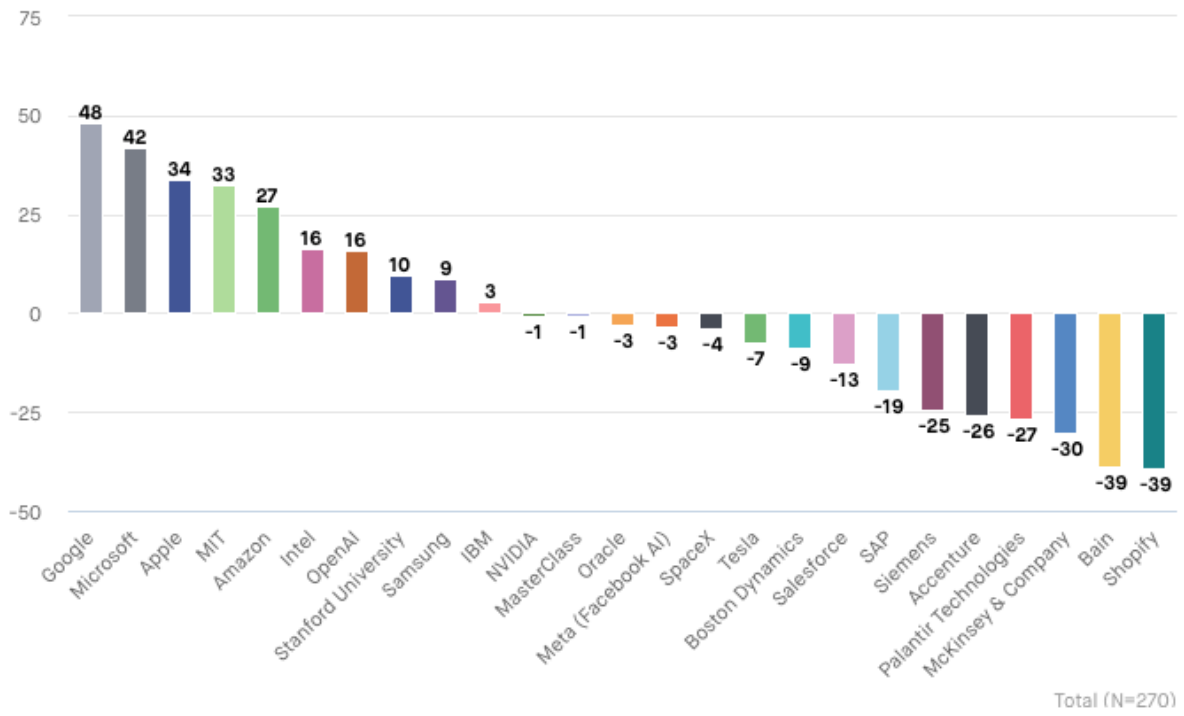

## Data Analysis & Decision Making

- Not a good standalone for us - hard skill
- More popular consumer data tools rise to the top - Google Analytics; Power BI
- Stanford ranks high



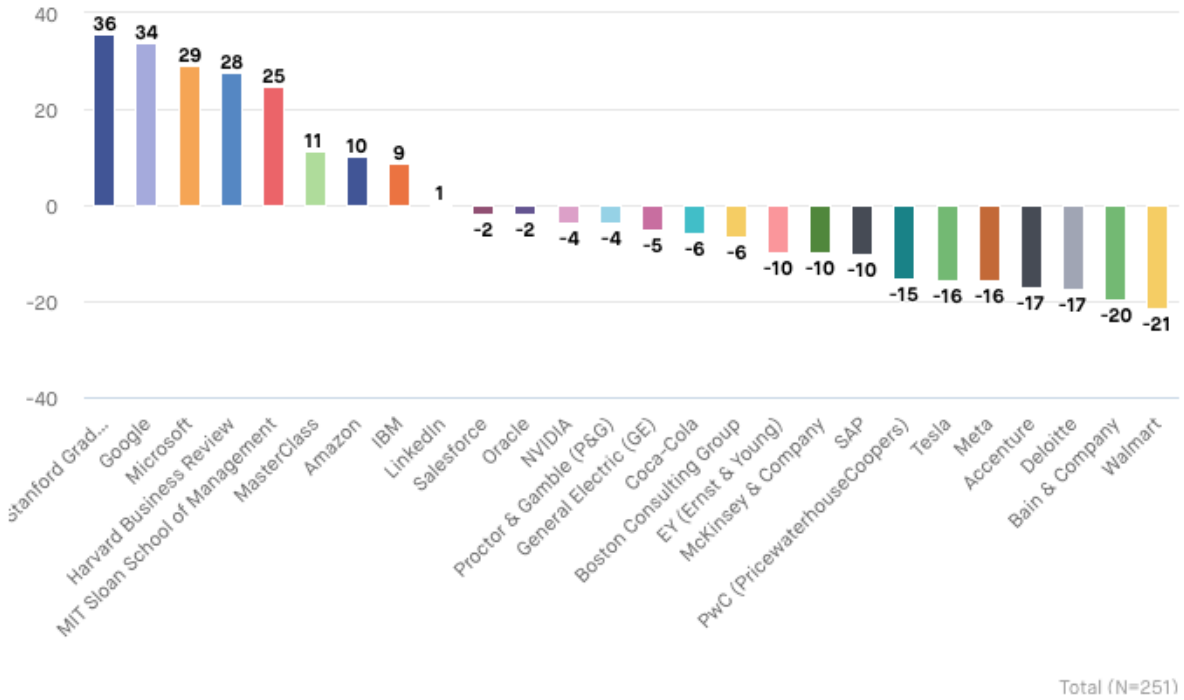

## Emerging Tech

- Not a good standalone for us
- Any popular consumer tech brand does well - Google, Microsoft, Apple, MIT, Amazon, Intel, OpenAI



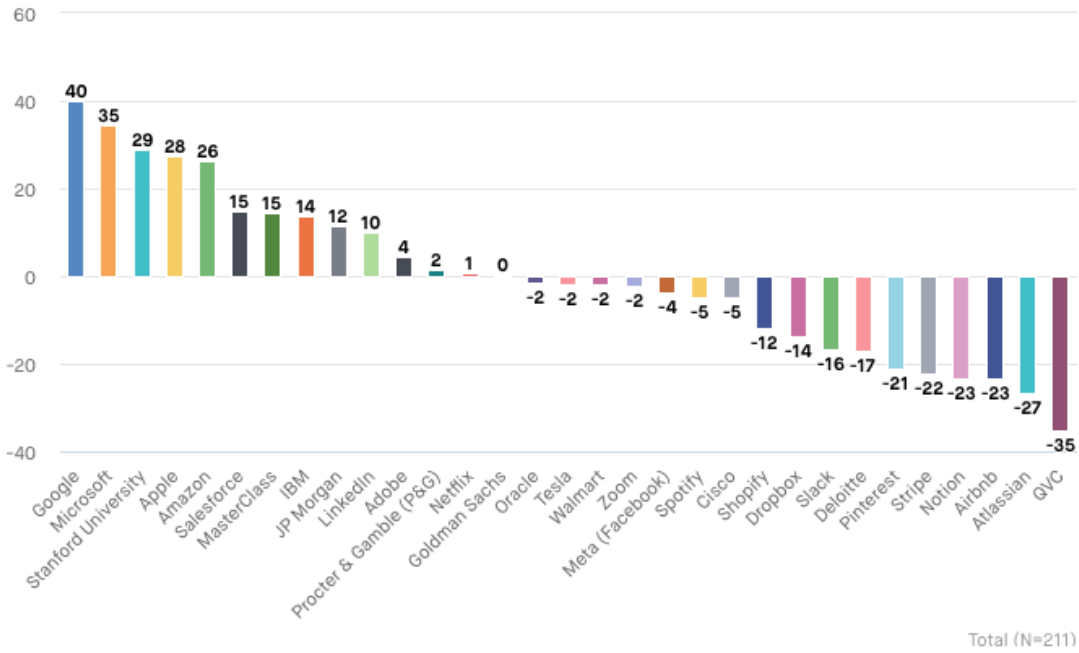

## Strategic Planning

- Strong university choice - Stanford, Harvard, and MIT all rank high
- In brands, Google, Microsoft, and Amazon
- MasterClass actually scores pretty well - around Amazon and IBM



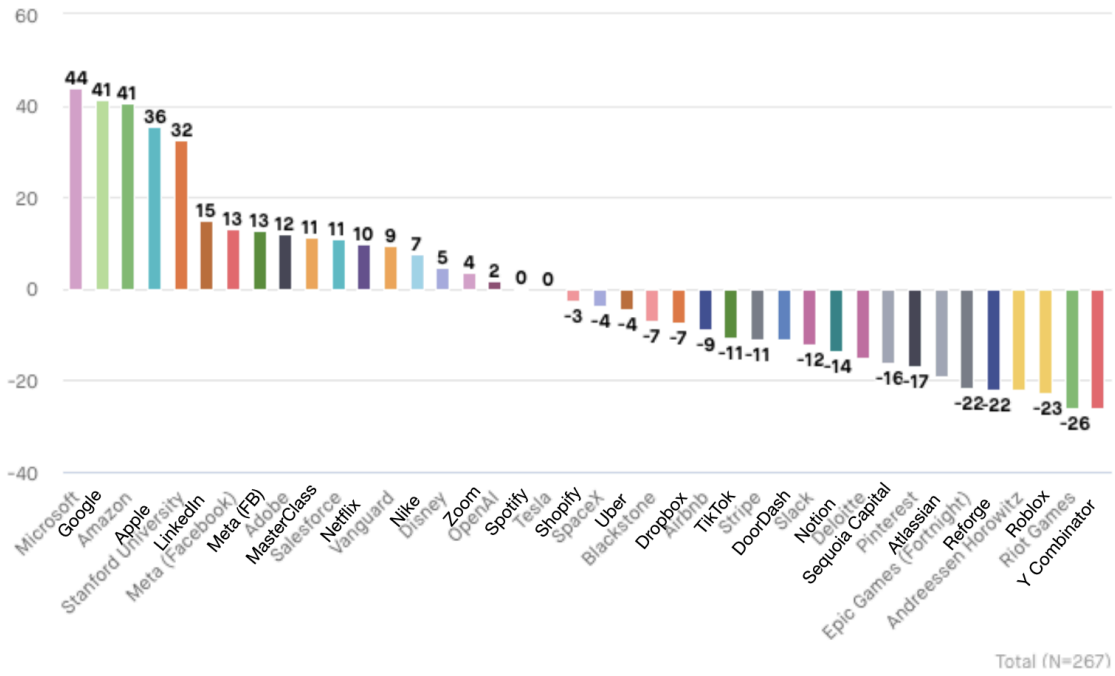

## Sales Leadership

- Big name brands score high.. QVC did not resonate at all
- SalesForce is a high scoring b2b brand
- Stanford and MasterClass also score positively



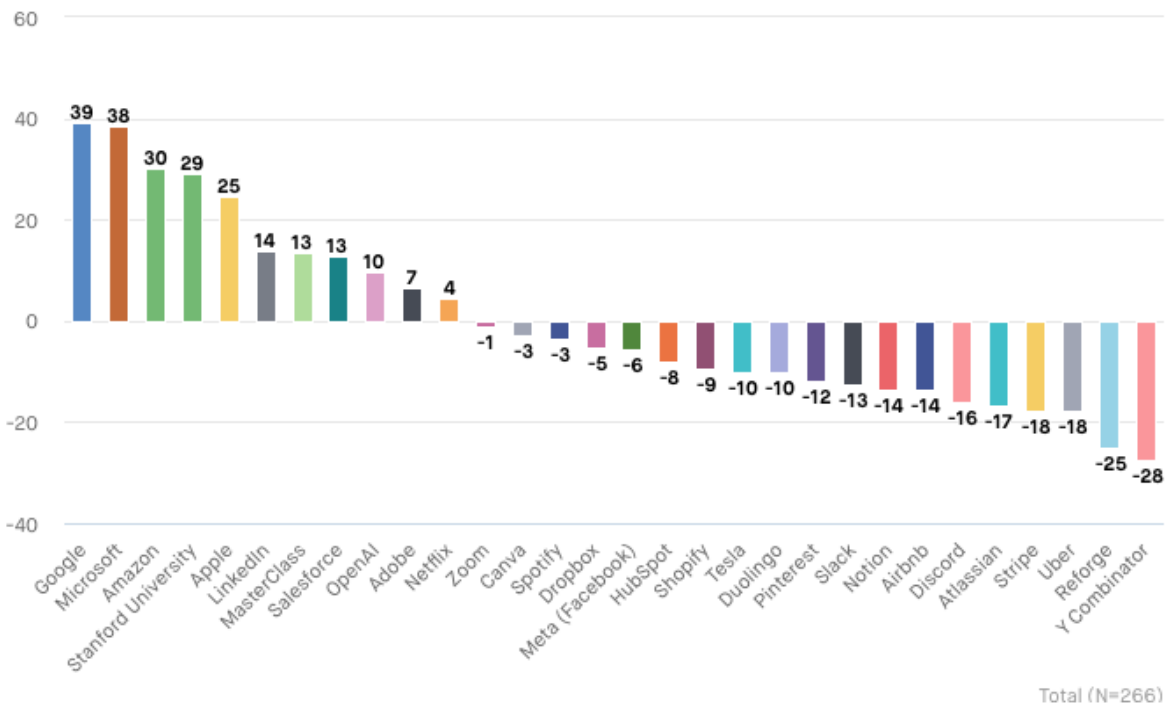
## Growth Strategy

- Many big name consumer tech brands score high
- MasterClass is positive, right around Adobe and Salesforce




## Product Management

- Many big name consumer tech brands score high
- MasterClass and Stanford also score high




## Product Marketing

- Many big name consumer tech brands score high
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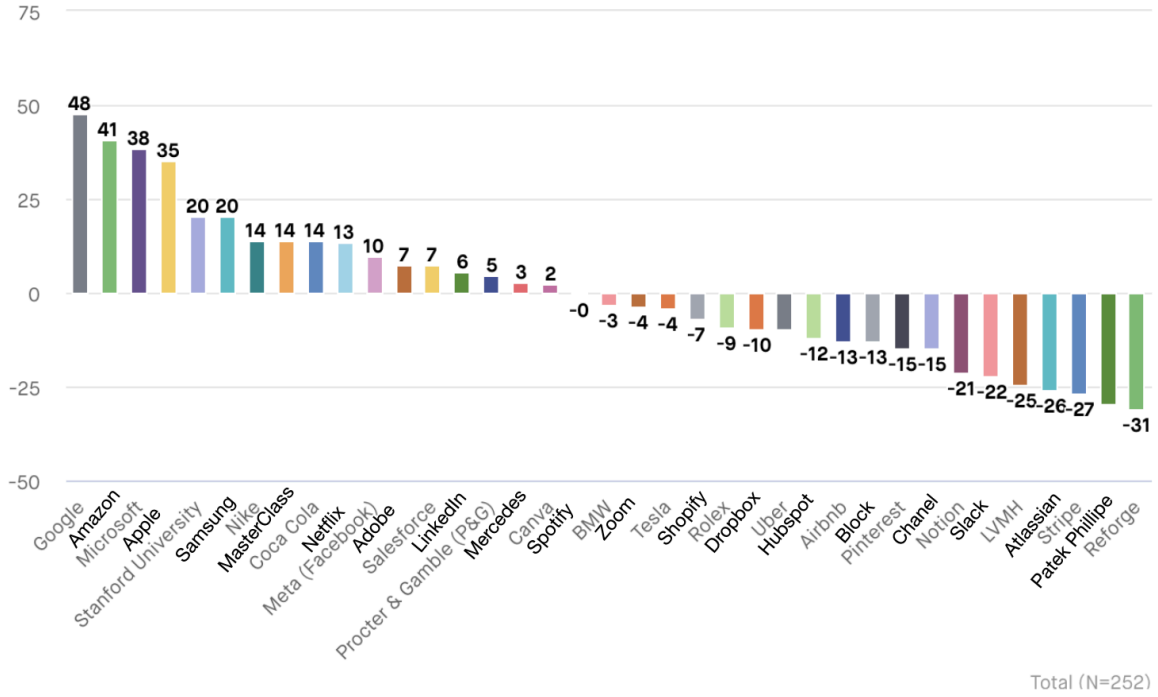
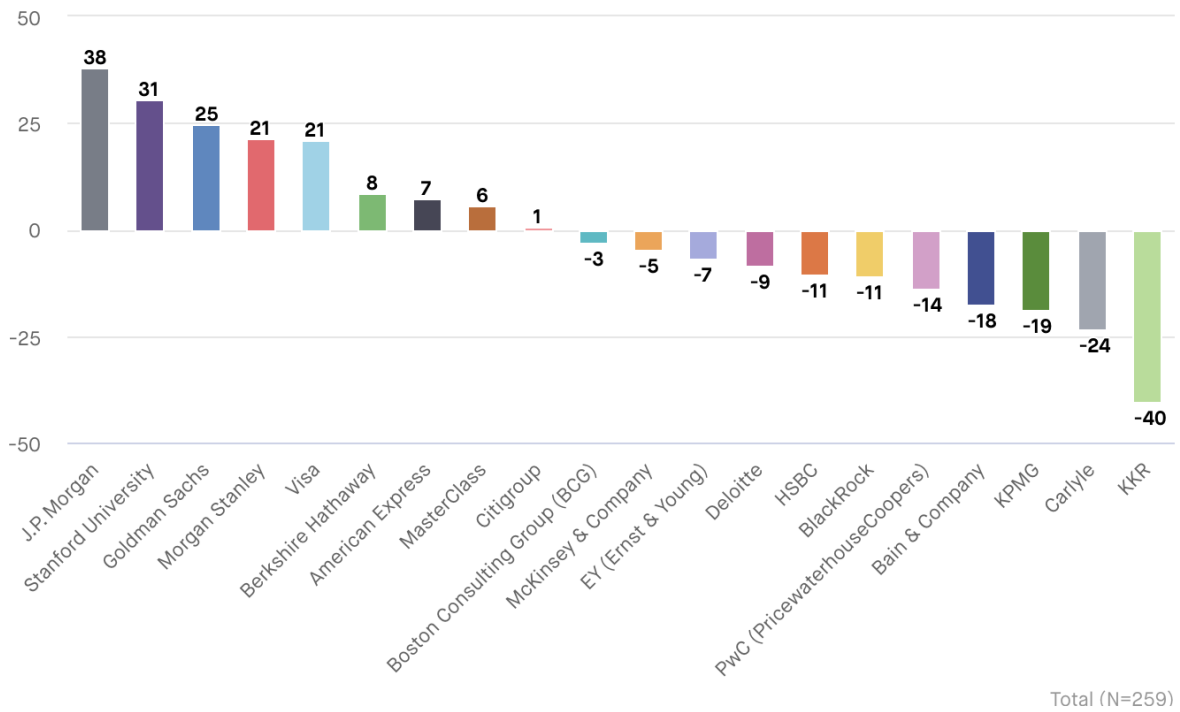


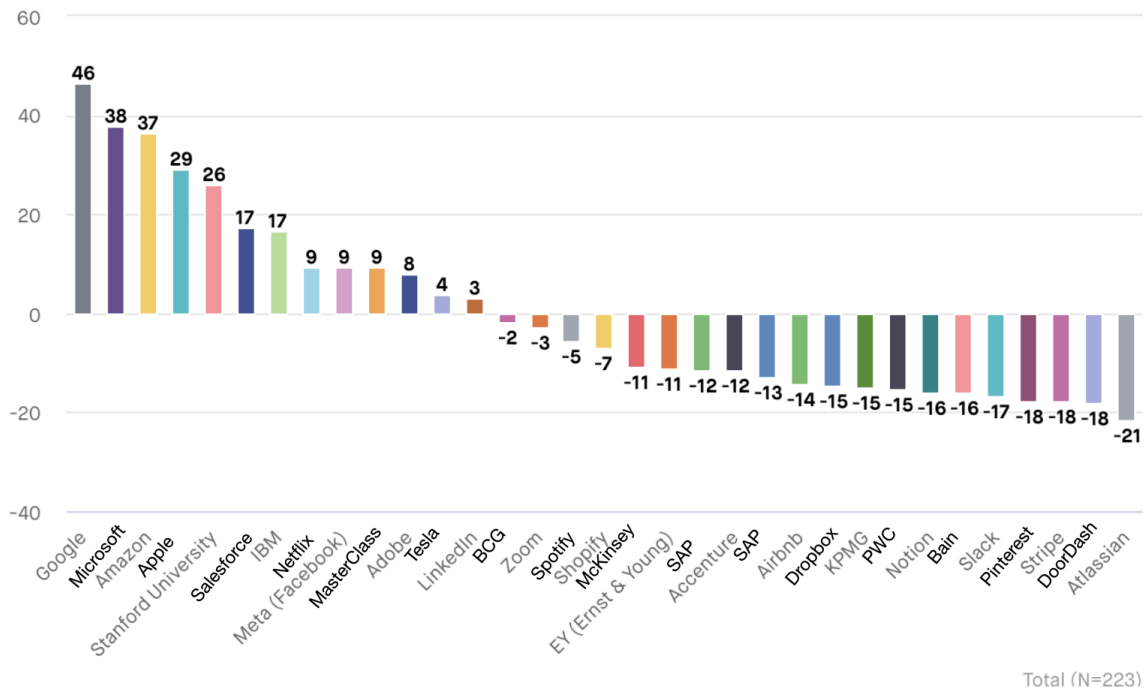
## Corporate Finance

- Pipeline brand Morgan Stanley ranks high; Carlyle ranks low



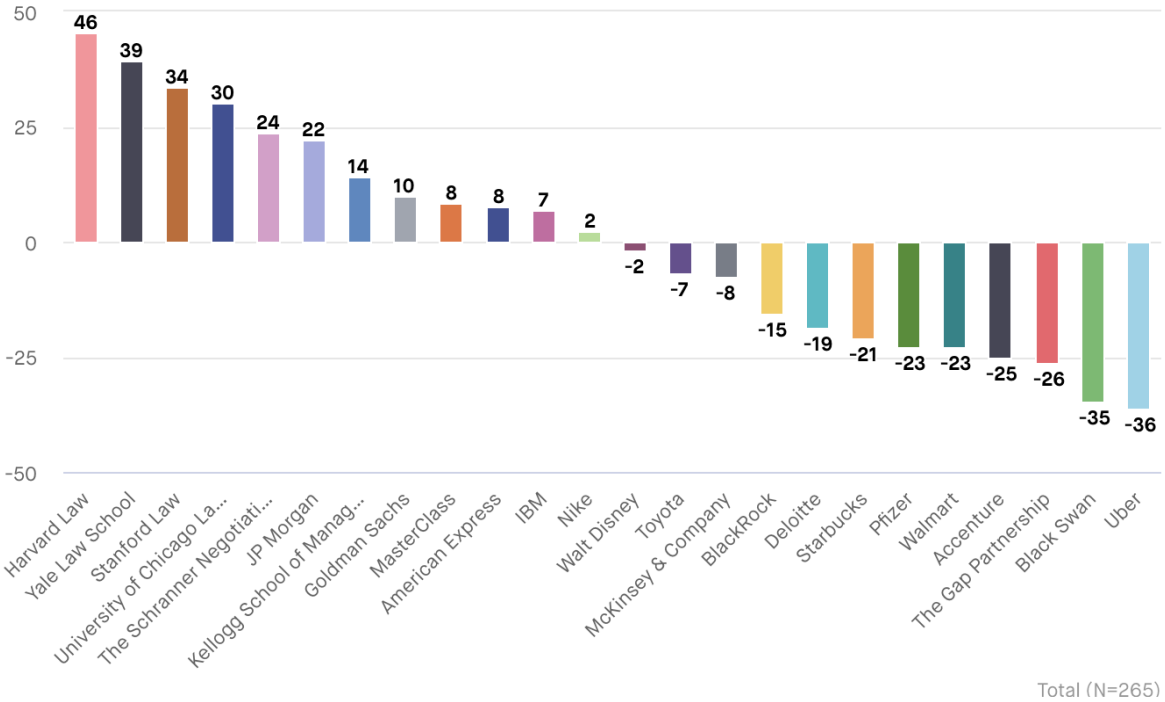

## Sales Strategy

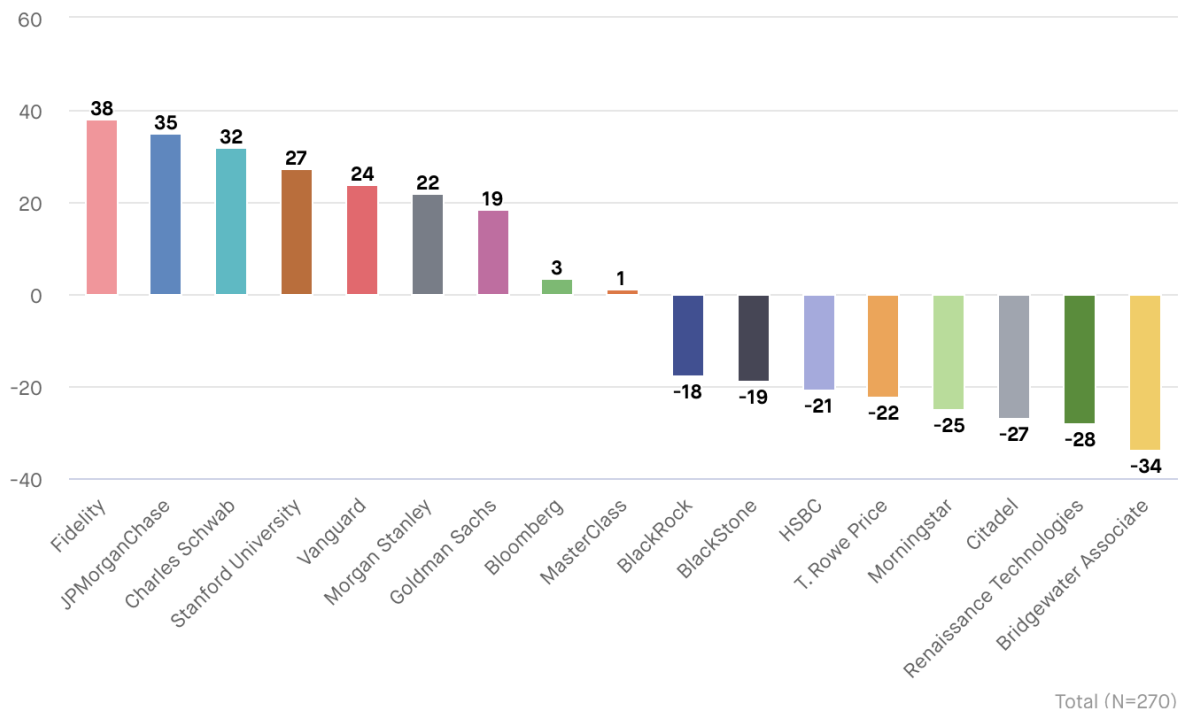
- Top consumer tech brands rank high




## Negotiation

- Academic law schools rank highest followed by finance



## Investment Analysis

- High consumer awareness finance brands rank at the top